

每年六月，中国各地同时举行大学的入学考试，中国人把这个考试叫做高考。这是全国高中生最重要的一个考试。这个考试不但决定他们进入哪所大学，同时也决定了他们以后四年的专业是什么。

我和几位北京的老师聊天儿，发现中国整个儿高中教育几乎都是在为高考做准备，学生很少有机会发展自己的兴趣。高考这个制度固然⁽¹⁾有些负面的影响，使许多高中学生只知道死记硬背，而⁽²⁾缺乏分析和理解的训练，但是这个考试制度却体现了公平竞争的精神。一个在农村长大的年轻人，只要通过考试，就可以跟别人一样⁽³⁾进入北京大学。我认为这种公平竞争的精神是非常有意义的。不靠关系，不走后门儿，完全靠自己的能力，通过考试，进入大学。在我看来⁽⁴⁾，这个考试的优点比缺点多得多。

有些人批评中国的教育制度过分强调记忆而不重视分析，这也许有些道理；但是在美国的中国留学生，一般来说，表现都很好。显然中国教育给他们的训练是很不错的。

生词：

高考	gāokǎo	<i>n.</i>	the entrance examination for colleges and universities
举行	jǔxíng	<i>v.</i>	hold (a meeting, ceremony, etc.)
入学	rùxué	<i>v.-o.</i>	start school; enter school 今年的新生都在九月入学。
重要	zhòngyào	<i>adj.</i>	important
决定	juéding	<i>v.</i>	determine
进入	jìnrù	<i>v.</i>	get into
整个儿	zhěnggèr	<i>adj.</i>	whole; entire (整个儿 is often used in conjunction with 都) 我整个儿晚上都没睡着。
发展	fāzhǎn	<i>v.</i>	develop
固然	gùrán	<i>conj.</i>	it is true that; no doubt
负面	fùmiàn	<i>adj.</i>	negative 起了负面作用 正面: positive
死记硬背	sǐjì yìngbèi	<i>v.</i>	rote memorizing
缺乏	quēfá	<i>v.</i>	lack; be short of 缺乏资源/缺乏远见
分析	fēnxī	<i>v./n.</i>	analyze, analysis
理解	lǐjiě	<i>v.</i>	comprehend

训练	xùnliàn	<i>n./v.</i>	training, train 受到很好的训练
体现	tǐxiàn	<i>v.</i>	embody; reflect; give expression to 这个做法体现了学校对学生的照顾。
公平	gōngpíng	<i>adj.</i>	fair; just
精神	jīngshén	<i>n.</i>	spirit
长大	zhǎngdà	<i>v.</i>	grow up; be brought up 她在大城市长大，没去过农村。
北京大学	Běijīng Dàxué	<i>n.</i>	Peking University
认为	rènwéi	<i>v.</i>	think
关系	guānxī	<i>n.</i>	connections; relationships
后门儿	hòuménr	<i>n.</i>	back door
走后门儿	zǒu hòuménr	<i>v.-o.</i>	get in by the back door; secure advantages through pull or influence

能力	nénglì	<i>n.</i>	ability; capability
在...看来	zài...kànlái		in one's opinion
优点	yōudiǎn	<i>n.</i>	good point; merit; strength
缺点	quēdiǎn	<i>n.</i>	shortcoming; defect; weakness
批评	pīpíng	<i>v.</i>	criticize
过分	guòfèn	<i>adv.</i>	excessively; over- 过分照顾孩子/过分重视考试的成绩
强调	qiángdiào	<i>v.</i>	emphasize; stress
记忆	jìyì	<i>n.</i>	memory
有道理	yǒu dào.li	<i>adj.</i>	reasonable
留学生	liúxuéshēng	<i>n.</i>	foreign student
表现	biǎoxiàn	<i>n.</i>	performance (in school, work, behavior)
显然	xiǎnrán	<i>adv.</i>	obviously

语法点

- (1) 高考这个制度固然有些负面的影响，但是却体现了公平竞争的精神。

While college entrance examinations undoubtedly have some negative effects, they do embody the spirit of fair competition.

固然 is a conjunction. It is often followed by 然而, 但是, 可是, 而 or 却 to express the speaker's actual viewpoint or to introduce another aspect of the matter concerned.

1. 电子工程固然是一个很难学的专业，但是毕业以后，可以很容易地找到年薪很高的工作。

Even though electric engineering is a hard subject to learn, but after graduation, it is very easy to find a high paying job.

2. 你不批评他，固然给了他面子，但是他就没办法知道自己的缺点了。

It is true that you helped him save face by not criticizing him, but now he has no way of knowing his shortcomings.

- (2) 许多高中学生只知道死记硬背，而缺乏分析和理解的训练。

Many high school students only know rote memorization and cold recitation while lacking training in analysis and understanding.

而 usually indicates that two things are contrary to each other.

However, 而 in this context is used to connect elements which are complementary to each other, indicating an addition. It may connect adjectives or descriptive phrases, or join verbal phrases. One cannot use 跟 in such cases despite this 而 having a very similar meaning to “and” in English.

1. 他坚持自己的看法，而不听别人的意见。

He insists on his own point of view and won't listen to the opinions of others.

2. 中国话里有许多生动而有趣的俗话。

There are many vivid and interesting proverbs in the Chinese language.

- (3) 一个生长在农村的年轻人，只要通过考试，就可以跟别人一样进入北京大学。

As long as he passes the examination, a young man from the countryside can enter Peking University like anyone else.

When 跟 is used to indicate a comparison between two things, it must be in conjunction with a word or phrase such as 一样, 相同, 差不多 or 不同.

1. 两年没见，你跟从前不一样了。

I haven't seen you in two years. You look different from before.

2. 在现代社会里，女人可以跟男人一样进大学，找工作。

In modern society, women can enter universities and look for jobs just as men do.

- (4) 在我看来，这个考试的优点比缺点多得多。

In my opinion, the merits of this examination outweigh the shortcomings.

在...看来 is used at the beginning of a sentence to introduce a person's opinion.

1. 在老师看来，考试是了解学生进步的一个好方法。

From a teacher's perspective, testing is a good method for understanding students' progress.

2. 在我看来，中国的高考体现了公平竞争的精神。

In my opinion, the college entrance examination in China embodies the spirit of fair competition

练习

I. Answer the following questions using the expressions when provided.

1. 在你的国家，有没有高考？（跟...一样）
2. 在你的大学，换专业难不难？（认为）
3. 你认为中国的高考怎么样？优点和缺点都是什么？(整个儿)

4. 你认为大学教育的目的 (mùdì, purpose) 是什么 ?
(为...做准备)
5. 一个人聪明不聪明 , 是不是学习好坏的主要原因 ? (固然)
6. 学习语言 , 需要不需要死记硬背 ? (在...看来)
7. 靠关系、走后门儿 , 是不是一件丢面子的事 ? (在...看来)
8. 学生们上课的时候为什么都睡觉了 ? (显然 , 缺乏)
9. 现在的独生子女为什么生活能力都很差 , 这跟父母对他们的教育有关系吗 ? (过分 , 照顾)
10. 中国各地高考的时间一样吗 ? (同时)

II. Translate into Chinese.

1. From a parent's viewpoint, passing the entrance examination and entering a famous university is perhaps the most important thing for one's child. Without a doubt (use 固然) this makes sense. However, in my view, this kind of examination system will only train students in rote memorization skills; it is meaningless in regards to a child's development.
2. Our educational system does not over-emphasize memorization and neglect the importance of analytical ability (能力). When preparing for the college entrance examination, we also offer opportunities for students to develop their own interests. I think our system has more strengths than weaknesses.
3. In the past, his speech lacked uniqueness/characteristics, but now his performance is quite different from when he was living in the village. Apparently, our training has given him a positive (正面) influence.